. Gulbadan Begum, *The History of Humayun*. Nizamuddin Ahmad writes that the shah's murderous thoughts were inspired by his younger brother, Bahram Khan, who was 'offended' when Humayun offered his own brothers' lack of loyalty as the reason for his exile (Nizamuddin Ahmad, 'Tabakat-i Akbari', in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 5 [Trübner and Co., 1873]). William Erskine relates an anecdote that clarifies the nature of Humayun's offence. Shah Tahmasp was hectoring his guest over dinner, declaring that Humayun would have been better off had he not let his brothers get out of hand. Afterwards, the shah summoned Bahram, whose duty it was to bring a basin and water for Tahmasp to wash his hands; and, as the younger brother bent to his task, the shah declared, 'This is the way in which you ought to have treated your brothers.' Humayun's enthusiastic concurrence with his tactless host is what angered Bahram Khan, and not without reason. See William Erskine's *A History of India Under the Two First Sovereigns of the House of Taimur: Báber and Humáyun* (Longman, Brown, Green and Longmans, 1854).

Humayun's fate was both uncertain in his own eyes and a mystery to the family he'd left behind. His uncle Haider, who had, indeed, marched on Kashmir and taken it as he'd wanted to, wrote in his account of Central Asian kings: 'The Emperor, after endless hardships and incalculable misfortunes, passed on to Irak, but up to the present time it is not known what has become of him.' See Mirza Muhammad Haider Dughlat, *The Tarikh-i-Rashidi: A History of the Moghuls of Central Asia*, trans. E. Denison Ross, ed. N. Elias (Sampson. Marston & Co., 1895).

. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*. Jouher stayed with Akbar when Humayun fled at Askari's approach, and accompanied the boy to Qandahar, then rejoined his padishah in Herat.

. Humayun was lucky to have these gifts to give, and wise to be submissive in the face of the shah's many provocations. Some years later, another refugee king in Tahmasp's court would be far less fortunate: Sultan Bayazid of Turkey, along with his four sons and 12,000 followers, was first given shelter then killed at the shah's orders (*The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*).

. Ibid., vol. 1.

. Ibid.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 2, trans. W.M. Thackston (Murty Classical Library of India, Harvard University Press, 2016). They met in Kabul's Shahrara Garden.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. Ibid.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 2, trans. W.M. Thackston.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.

.'Goats' might be a mistranslation; as my editor, Nandini Mehta, informs me, it is sheep, not goat, that was and remains the most popular meat in the Central Asian diet.

. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*. Cow flesh was considered as unappetizing as horsemeat, it seems, not only by the Central Asian Timurids, but also by the Indian Muslims they conquered. One of the latter, Abdul Qadir Badauni, describes the predicament of a besieged Deccani amir called Muqarrab Khan, whose forces were 'reduced to eating the flesh of horses, camels, and cows, and the matter touched the life, and the knife reached the bone' (Abdul Qadir Badauni. *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* (Selections from Histories), vol. 2, trans. W.H. Lowe (First published 1884–98; Atlantic Publishers and Distributors, 1990).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. Freer Gallery of Art: https://asia.si.edu/object/F1939.57/

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 2, trans. W.M. Thackston.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. Ibid.

. Iqtidar Alam Khan, *The Political Biography of a Mughal Noble: Mun'im Khan Khan-i Khanan, 1497–1575* (Orient Longman, 1973).